DBCS STAFFING (8/24/16)

1. Is the current Delivery Bar Code Sorter System (DBCS) normal staffing of two (2) clerks per machine a minimum requirement to address certain safety and ergonomic issues as identified by the APWU?

Response: Pursuant to Article 14, Section 1 ***"It is the responsibility of management to provide safe working conditions in all present and future installations and to develop a safe working force"*** **and in accordance with the Employee and Labor Relations Manual (ELM), Section 891,** ***Authority, "The Postal Service complies with applicable federal laws, regulations, and OSHA guidance materials regarding ergonomics."***

2. Does the 2012 JCIM, Article 37, page 76, ***OCR – BCS – DBCS STAFFING*** **Questions and Answers, address the only exceptions to the normal staffing of two (2) Mail Processing Clerks on the DBCS at all times?**

Response: Yes. During the exception periods described in the 2012 JCIM Q&As, the second Mail Processing Clerk may perform allied duties as assigned in the OCR-BCS-DBCS area.

3. Does the 2016 language address minimum staffing?

Response: Yes, and the 2016 language is not intended to impact those offices where there have been agreements and past practices involving more than two clerks per machine (due to unique rotations or other local factors.)

OCR – BCS – DBCS STAFFING

Normal staffing for the OCR, BCS and/or DBCS will be two (2) Mail Processing Clerks to perform the loading, feeding and sweeping functions.

1. Does the settlement mean that there must always be two (2) Mail Processing Clerks assigned to the OCR, BCS and/or DBCS?

Response: No, that is the normal staffing.

2. Would it be a violation if there was only one (1) clerk working on the OCR, BCS and/or DBCS at the start of the run?

Response: No. There may not be a need for two (2) Mail Processing Clerks at start up or close out.

3. Would it be a violation if there was only one (1) clerk working on the OCR, BCS or DBCS because of the limited volume for that sort program?

Response: Once again, the "normal" staffing is two (2) Mail Processing Clerks, but there may be circumstances where the staffing is reduced.

4. Would low volume zone runs be an example?

Response: Yes, if the volume available for a DPS zone is such that there is no or minimal sweeping activity required during the run, one (1) operator may be sufficient. One (1) operator may also be sufficient if the volume is such that one (1) operator can load, then sweep before the bins fill up, and then return to loading.

This settlement addresses minimum staffing, and is not intended to impact those offices where there have been agreements involving more than two (2) operators per machine (due to unique rotations or other local factors.)